PEW RESEARCH CENTER
October 12-14, 2012 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,006

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
October 12-14, 2012	42	28	14	15	1
October 4-7, 2012	40	29	13	17	*
September 27-30, 2012	34	37	13	15	1
September 20-23, 2012	36	32	17	15	*
September 13-16, 2012	38	32	17	12	1
September 7-9, 2012	36	31	17	15	2
August 31-September 3, 2012	33	31	20	16	1
August 23-26, 2012	38	30	15	16	1
August 16-19, 2012	33	32	16	19	*
August 9-12, 2012	30	31	20	18	1
August 2-5, 2012	33	29	20	17	1
July 26-29, 2012	32	30	20	19	*
July 19-22, 2012	39	29	16	16	*
July 12-15, 2012	32	33	18	17	1
July 5-8, 2012	34	28	18	19	1
June 28-July 1, 2012	38	28	15	18	1
June 21-24, 2012	33	32	17	17	*
June 14-17, 2012	39	28	15	17	*
June 7-10, 2012	35	32	15	18	*
May 31-June 3, 2012	37	34	13	14	1
May 24-27, 2012	33	31	19	16	1
May 17-20, 2012	35	30	16	19	*
May 10-13, 2012	40	26	16	17	*
May 3-6, 2012	38	29	13	20	*
April 26-29, 2012	34	32	17	16	1
April 19-22, 2012	35	35	13	14	2
April 12-15, 2012	39	28	16	17	1
April 5-8, 2012	37	31	16	16	1
March 29-April 1, 2012	34	33	15	18	1
March 22-25, 2012	36	29	16	18	1
March 15-18, 2012	40	35	11	14	1
March 8-11, 2012	37	32	14	17	*
March 1-4, 2012	41	27	15	17	1
February 23-26, 2012	37	33	14	15	1
February 16-20, 2012	33	32	16	17	1
February 9-12, 2012	42	30	14	13	1
February 2-5, 2012	38	32	16	13	1
January 26-29, 2012	35	31	16	19	*
January 19-22, 2012	35	30	16	19	1
January 12-15, 2012	33	32	14	20	1
January 5-8, 2012	39	31	15	15	*
December 15-18, 2011	36	32	14	16	1
December 8-11, 2011	41	29	13	16	1
December 1-4, 2011	40	33	13	13	1
November 17-20, 2011	35	33	16	15	1
November 10-13, 2011	39	31	15	14	*
November 3-6, 2011	37	31	15	17	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
October 27-30, 2011	38	33	14	15	1
October 20-23, 2011	38	32	14	16	1
October 13-16, 2011	39	32	14	14	*
October 6-9, 2011	43	28	14	14	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	46	26	14	14	*
September 22-25, 2011	44	33	11	11	*
September 8-11, 2011	40	30	15	14	1
September 1-4, 2011	44	30	11	15	*
August 25-28, 2011	44	28	14	13	1
August 18-21, 2011	44	29	12	14	1
August 4-7, 2011	46	30	11	13	1
July 28-31, 2011	43	30	13	13	*
July 21-24, 2011	41	32	13	13	1
July 14-17, 2011	41	30	14	14	1
July 7-10, 2011	36	30	15	18	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	38	32	13	16	1
June 23-26, 2011	37	29	15	19	*
June 16-19, 2011	39	33	14	13	*
June 9-12, 2011	39	30	15	16	1
June 2-5, 2011	35	34	17	14	*
May 19-22, 2011	33	34	17	16	*
May 12-15, 2011	32	32	17	18	2
May 5-8, 2011	40	35	15	9	1
April 21-25, 2011	41	33	12	14	*
April 14-17, 2011	44	30	14	12	1
April 7-10, 2011	46	30	14	10	*
March 31-April 3, 2011	42	31	16	11	0
March 24-27, 2011	36	32	17	15	*
March 17-20, 2011	38	32	17	13	*
March 10-13, 2011	40	30	16	13	*
March 3-6, 2011	37	31	17	13	1
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2011	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Economy-Trends.pdf

b. Investigations into last month's attack on the U.S. embassy in Libya					
October 12-14, 2012	28	28	19	23	1
October 4-7, 2012: *Investigations into the attack on the U.S. embassy in Libya earlier this month*	27	24	20	28	1
September 13-16, 2012: *Attacks on American embassies and consulates in the Middle East and the killing of the U.S. ambassador in Libya*	43	24	15	17	1
c. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential election					
October 12-14, 2012	45	26	13	14	1
October 4-7, 2012	45	23	15	17	*
September 27-30, 2012	40	30	14	14	1
September 20-23, 2012	38	29	16	17	*
September 13-16, 2012	42	25	18	15	1
September 7-9, 2012	31	31	18	19	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
August 31-September 3, 2012	29	29	20	20	1
August 23-26, 2012	27	31	19	22	1
August 16-19, 2012	32	27	19	22	1
August 9-12, 2012	27	27	21	24	1
August 2-5, 2012	31	25	19	23	1
July 26-29, 2012	25	28	21	25	1
July 19-22, 2012	35	22	17	25	1
July 12-15, 2012	33	24	20	23	*
July 5-8, 2012	29	26	20	25	*
June 28-July 1, 2012	32	24	19	25	*
June 21-24, 2012	27	30	17	25	1
June 14-17, 2012	31	30	15	24	*
June 7-10, 2012	30	29	16	25	1
May 31-June 3, 2012	29	28	19	23	1
May 24-27, 2012	32	28	16	24	1
May 17-20, 2012	31	26	19	23	*
May 10-13, 2012	34	23	18	24	*
May 3-6, 2012	29	27	19	24	*
April 26-29, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
April 19-22, 2012	29	29	20	20	1
April 12-15, 2012	32	28	16	23	1
April 5-8, 2012	31	27	18	23	*
March 29-April 1, 2012	23	29	21	27	*
March 22-25, 2012	28	28	18	25	1
March 15-18, 2012	28	31	17	24	*
March 8-11, 2012	28	27	21	23	*
March 1-4, 2012	31	24	20	24	1
February 23-26, 2012	28	29	18	24	1
February 16-20, 2012	25	29	19	25	2
February 9-12, 2012	35	25	18	20	1
February 2-5, 2012	30	27	20	21	1
January 26-29, 2012	28	30	21	21	1
January 19-22, 2012	28	30	17	24	*
January 12-15, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
January 5-8, 2012	29	30	16	25	*
December 15-18, 2011	26	24	20	29	1
December 8-11, 2011	27	27	18	28	*
December 1-4, 2011	25	28	20	26	1
November 17-20, 2011	24	31	21	23	1
November 3-6, 2011	22	31	20	26	1
October 27-30, 2011	21	26	21	30	1
October 20-23, 2011	21	28	22	28	1
October 13-16, 2011	26	29	22	23	1
October 6-9, 2011	25	25	23	27	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	27	26	21	25	*
September 22-25, 2011	25	26	23	25	1
September 15-18, 2011	24	28	21	27	1
September 8-11, 2011	22	26	21	31	*
September 1-4, 2011	22	23	22	32	1
August 25-28, 2011	22	22	22	33	1
August 18-21, 2011	27	26	19	28	1
August 11-14, 2011	19	24	20	36	1
August 4-7, 2011	18	21	22	37	1
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Election-Trends.pdf

NO QUESTIONS PEW.2-PEW.4

In the presidential campaign so far…
RANDOMIZE ORDER OF PEW.5 AND PEW.6
ASK ALL:
PEW.5 (And) Do you think Barack Obama has been too personally critical of Mitt Romney, or not?

BASED ON REGISTERED VOTERS [N=857]

		Too personally critical	Not too personally critical	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
	Oct 12-14, 2012	35	51	15
	Jun 7-17, 2012	30	61	9
Obama/McCain	November, 2008[1] (*voters*)	21	76	3
	Early October, 2008	22	69	9
	Mid-September, 2008	28	65	7
	June, 2008	19	73	8
Kerry/Bush	September, 2004	52	45	3
	June, 2004	44	48	8
	Mid-March 2004	48	46	6
Gore/Bush	Early October, 2000	29	61	10
Clinton/Dole	Late September, 1996	21	70	9
Dukakis/Bush, Sr.	October, 1988	45	50	5

[1] Question in November 2008 was worded "… was too personally critical …"

RANDOMIZE ORDER OF PEW.5 AND PEW.6
ASK ALL:
PEW.6 (And) do you think Mitt Romney has been too personally critical of Barack Obama, or not?

BASED ON REGISTERED VOTERS [N=857]

		Too personally critical	Not too personally critical	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
	Oct 12-14, 2012	37	48	15
	Jun 7-17, 2012	43	49	9
McCain/Obama	November, 2008[2] (*voters*)	49	48	3
	Early October, 2008	48	44	8
	Mid-September, 2008	42	52	6
	June, 2008	26	65	9
Bush/Kerry	September, 2004	49	47	4
	June, 2004	33	58	9
	Mid-March 2004	33	58	9
Bush/Gore	Early October, 2000	40	50	10
Dole/Clinton	Late September, 1996	53	40	7
Bush, Sr./Dukakis	October, 1988	52	43	5

ASK ALL:
PEW.7 Did you happen to watch the vice-presidential debate between **[RANDOMIZE:** Joe Biden and Paul Ryan**]** on Thursday night, or didn't you get a chance to see it? **[IF YES, ASK**: How much of the debate did you watch: all of it, some of it, or only a little?**]**

BASED ON REGISTERED VOTERS [N=857]:

		NET Yes	Yes, all	Yes, some	Yes, a little	No, didn't watch	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
Ryan/Biden	Oct 12-14, 2012	60	42	13	5	40	1
Palin/Biden	Oct 3-6, 2008	76	53	18	5	24	*
TREND FOR COMPARISON:							
	Romney/Obama						
	Oct 4-7, 2012	69	43	20	6	31	*
	McCain/Obama						
	Sep 27-29, 2008	60	34	20	6	39	1
	Bush/Kerry						
	Early Oct, 2004	69	41	22	6	31	*
	Bush/Gore						
	Early Oct, 2000	63	32	24	7	37	*

ASK ALL:
PEW.8 **[IF WATCHED DEBATE (PEW.7=1-3):** Regardless of who you support; **IF DID NOT WATCH DEBATE (PEW.7=4,9):** From what you've heard or read**]**, which vice-presidential candidate do you think did the better job in the debate **[RANDOMIZE:** Joe Biden or Paul Ryan**]**?

BASED ON REGISTERED VOTERS [N=857]:

Oct 12-14 2012	
41	Joe Biden
38	Paul Ryan
5	Neither/Both **(VOL.)**
16	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

[2] Question in November 2008 was worded "… was too personally critical …"

ASK ALL:
The next PRESIDENTIAL debate is on Tuesday night…
PEW.9 How likely is it that you will watch the upcoming debate between Mitt Romney and Barack Obama this coming Tuesday – very likely, somewhat likely or not likely?

BASED ON REGISTERED VOTERS [N=857]

	Very likely	Somewhat likely	Not likely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
October 12-14, 2012	68	15	16	*
September 27-30, 2012	62	21	17	0
October 3-6, 2008[3]	70	18	12	*
September 19-22, 2008 *(GP)*	58	24	18	*
Early October, 2004	59	29	11	1
Early September, 2004	61	27	11	1
Early October, 2000	49	31	19	1
Late September, 2000	43	31	22	4
September, 1996	43	34	22	1
CBS/NYT: 1992	67	24	8	2
CBS/NYT: 1988	55	27	17	1
CBS/NYT: 1984	55	27	16	2

ASK ALL:
PEW.10 Regardless of which candidate you support, who do you think will do the better job in the presidential debate **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**?

BASED ON REGISTERED VOTERS [N=857]

Oct 12-14 2012		Sep 27-30 2012
37	Mitt Romney	29
41	Barack Obama	51
1	Both will do equally well **(VOL.)**	2
3	Neither **(VOL.)**	2
18	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	16

NO QUESTIONS PEW.11-PEW.12

[3] October 3-6, 2008 asked about the debate between John McCain and Barack Obama. September 19-22, 2008 asked about the upcoming foreign policy debate between John McCain and Barack Obama, and figures are based on general public results. In early October, 2004 the question asked: "How likely is it that you will watch either of the upcoming presidential debates between Bush and Kerry this coming Friday, or next Wednesday?" In early September, 2004 the question asked: "How likely is it that you will watch the upcoming presidential debates between John Kerry and George W. Bush?" In late September and early October, 2000 the question asked: "How likely is it that you will watch the upcoming presidential debates between Al Gore and George W. Bush?" In September, 1996 the question asked: "How likely is it that you will watch the upcoming Presidential debates between Bill Clinton and Bob Dole?" The CBS/NYT surveys asked, "How likely is it that you will watch next/this Sunday's debate between ...?" The 1988 survey is based on the probable electorate.

ASK ALL:
Thinking about the terrorist attack on the U.S. consulate in Libya last month in which a U.S. ambassador was killed…
PEW.13 From what you've seen and heard, do you approve or disapprove of how the Obama administration has handled this situation?

Oct 12-14 2012	
35	Approve
38	Disapprove
27	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

TREND FOR COMPARISON

ASK IF FOLLOWED MIDDLE-EAST ATTACKS:
Thinking about the recent attacks on U.S. embassies and consulates in the Middle East and the killing of the U.S. ambassador in Libya
From what you've seen and heard, do you approve or disapprove of how Barack Obama has handled this situation?

BASED ON THOSE FOLLOWING MIDDLE-EAST ATTACKS:

Sep 13-16 2012	
45	Approve
36	Disapprove
19	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:
PEW.14 How much, if anything, have you heard about each of the following? **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**

		A lot	A little	Nothing at all	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a.	That the U.S. embassy in Libya had requested more security prior to the attacks but did not receive it				
	Oct 12-14, 2012	30	34	33	2
b.	That the Obama Administration incorrectly said there were public protests outside the embassy at the time of the attacks				
	Oct 12-14, 2012	26	34	37	2